

Jeffrey Weng
翁哲瑞

Department of Sociology
National Taiwan University
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Appointments

NATIONAL TAIWAN UNIVERSITY
Assistant Professor of Sociology, 2021–present

STANFORD UNIVERSITY
Shorenstein Postdoctoral Fellow on Contemporary Asia, 2020–21

Education

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY
Ph.D. in Sociology, 2020
M.A. in Sociology, 2014

YALE UNIVERSITY
B.A. in Political Science and International Studies, 2008

Publications

BOOK

Weng, Jeffrey. Forthcoming. *With One Voice: Mandarin's Conquest of China*. Stanford: Stanford University Press.

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

Weng, Jeffrey. 2023. "Stop the Presses! Publishing Chinese Character Simplification, 1935–1936." *Harvard Journal of Asiatic Studies* 83(2): 333–364.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2020. "End of an Era: Transforming Language and Society in Japan, Korea, and Vietnam, ca. 1870–1950." *European Journal of Sociology* 61(2): 269–299.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2020. "Uneasy Companions: Language and Human Collectivities in the Remaking of Chinese Society in the Early Twentieth Century." *Theory & Society* 49(1):75–100.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2018. "What is Mandarin? The Social Project of Language Standardization in Early Republican China." *Journal of Asian Studies* 77(3): 611–633.

BOOK CHAPTERS

Weng, Jeffrey. 2020. "Vernacular Language Movement." *Oxford Bibliographies in Chinese Studies*. Ed. Tim Wright. New York: Oxford University Press.

Lie, John and Jeffrey Weng. 2020. "East Asia." Pp. 129–146 in *The Wiley Blackwell Companion to Race, Ethnicity, and Nationalism*, edited by John Stone, Polly Rizova, Rutledge M. Dennis, and Xiaoshuo Hou. Chichester: John Wiley & Sons.

BOOK REVIEWS

Weng, Jeffrey. 2024. "Sound, Meaning, Shape: The Phonologist Wei Jiangong (1901–1980) between Language Study and Language Planning, by Mariana Münning." *Bulletin of the Institute of Modern History, Academia Sinica* 121:191–197.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2023. "Kingdom of Characters: The Language Revolution That Made China Modern, by Jing Tsu." *The Journal of Asian Studies* 82(3): 471–472.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2017. "The Rural Modern: Reconstructing the Self and State in Republican China, by Kate Merkel-Hess." *The China Review* 17(3):190–194.

Invited talks

Weng, Jeffrey. 2022. "What is Mandarin? Designing a New Language for a New Nation." International Chinese Language Program, National Taiwan University. Taipei, Taiwan.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2022. "The Transformation of Language and Society in Japan, Korea, and Vietnam, c. 1870–1950." Global Asia Research Center, National Taiwan University. Taipei, Taiwan.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2022. "Out in the Field in the Archives: One Historical Sociologist's Perspective on the Discipline." Department of Sociology, National Chengchi University, Taipei, Taiwan

Weng, Jeffrey. 2021. "Chinese Character Simplification and the Publishing Industry, 1935–1936." Colloquium. Institute of Modern History, Academia Sinica. Taipei, Taiwan.

Conference & workshop presentations

Weng, Jeffrey (panel organizer and presenter) 2026 (upcoming). "By the Book: Heritage-Language Education among Taiwanese and Chinese Immigrants to the U.S. since the 1970s." *Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference*. Panel, "The Nation Overseas: Language and Institutions among the Republic of China's Diasporas in the US, Southeast Asia, and Latin America." Vancouver, Canada.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2024. "Deviance, Determinism, and Denial: China in the Reconsideration of Language in Nationalism and State-Building." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Section on Comparative-Historical Sociology. Roundtable. Montreal, Canada.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2023. "Out of Many Voices, One: Language in the Reinvention of the Chinese Nation." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Section on Comparative-Historical Sociology. Panel, "Historical Sociology of Political and Economic Formations." Philadelphia, PA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2022. "Meritocracy vs. Egalitarianism in Language and Education: China in the 1930s." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Section on Global and Transnational Sociology, refereed roundtable. Los Angeles, CA.

Weng, Jeffrey (panel organizer, chair, and presenter). 2022. "Hiding in Plain Sight: Language and the Construction of China's Ethnoracial Majority." *Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference*. Panel, "The Outsiders Within: Contesting Majority and Minority Peoplehood in Modern and Contemporary China." Honolulu, HI.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2021. "Bourdieu in China: Language and Symbolic Power Beyond Western Models." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Regular Session, Sociological Theory.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2021. "Hiding in Plain Sight: Language and the Construction of the World's Largest Ethnoracial Group." University of Tokyo / National Taiwan University Sociology Forum. Taipei, Taiwan.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2020. "Hiding in Plain Sight: Language and the Construction of the World's Largest Ethnoracial Group." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Panel, "Internal Boundaries and Multinational States." San Francisco, CA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2019. "Hiding in Plain Sight: Language and the Construction of the World's Largest Ethnoracial Group." Center for Culture, Organizations, and Politics Workshop. University of California, Berkeley.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2019. "Who are You Calling Anomalous? Eurocentric Explanations of the Rise of National Standard Languages and the Chinese Case." *The Eleventh International Convention of Asia Scholars*. Panel, "Sounding Chinese: Evolving Notions of Nation, Language and Identity." Leiden University, International Institute for Asian Studies. Leiden, Netherlands.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2019. "Stop the Presses! Character Simplification and the Publishing Industry in China Under the Nationalists, 1935–1936." *Languages and Scripts in China: New Directions in Information and Communications History*. Workshop at Columbia University. New York, NY.

Weng, Jeffrey (panel organizer and presenter). 2019. "Spreading the Word: National Language Education in China in the 1920s and 1930s." *Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference*. Panel, "Finding the Nation's Voice: Language Ideologies and the Remaking of Mandarin in Twentieth-Century Mainland China and Taiwan." Denver, CO.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2018. "The Political Economy of Spelling: The Publishing Industry and Character Simplification in China under the Nationalists, 1935–1936." *American*

Sociological Association Annual Meeting. Section on Comparative Historical Sociology, refereed roundtable. Philadelphia, PA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2017. "The End of East Asian Linguistic Cosmopolitanism: Japan, Korea, and Vietnam, ca. 1850–1950." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Section on Asia and Asian America, refereed roundtable. Montreal, Canada.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2016. "What is Mandarin? The Invention of a National Standard Language in Early Republican China." *East Asia as Method: Culture, Knowledge, Space*, Institute of East Asian Studies Haas Junior Scholars Program for Doctoral Candidates. Berkeley, CA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2016. "Language, Class, and Nation: The Rise of a National Lingua Franca and the Problem of Equity." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Comparative-Historical Section, Refereed Roundtable. Seattle, WA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2016. "What is Mandarin? Nationalism and Linguistic Modernity in Early Twentieth Century China." *Colloquium Talk*. Nanjing University, School of Social and Behavioral Sciences. Nanjing, China.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2016. "What is Mandarin? Evolving Notions of Language and Peoplehood in Early Twentieth-Century China." *Language, Power and Identity in Asia: Creating and Crossing Language Boundaries*. Leiden University, International Institute for Asian Studies. Leiden, Netherlands.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2015. "Linguistic Modernity: The Limits of Ideology and State Power in the Creation of Modern Standard Languages." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Theory Section regular session panel, "Theorizing Inequality." Chicago, IL.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2015. "Linguistic Modernity: The Limits of Ideology and State Power in the Creation of Modern Standard Languages." *Junior Theorists Symposium*. Panel, "The State and Globalization." Chicago, IL.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2015. "Linguistic Modernity: The Limits of Ideology and State Power in the Creation of Modern Standard Languages." *Social Science History Association Annual Meeting*. Panel, "Fields and Disciplines." Baltimore, MD.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2014. "Language and Nation-Building in Early Twentieth-Century China: A Critique of Bourdieu." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Theory Section, refereed roundtable. San Francisco, CA.

Fellowships and grants

2030 Cross-Generation Emerging Young Scholars Grant, 2025–2028
Taiwan National Science and Technology Council Grant, 2023–25
The Catherine and William L. Magistretti Graduate Fellowship, 2019–20
Metro New York Leaders Fellowship, 2018–19

Chiang Ching-kuo Foundation Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship, 2017–18
 National Science Foundation Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant, 2016–17
 Finalist, Harvard Academy Scholars Postdoctoral Fellowship, Harvard Academy for International and Area Studies (10 finalists chosen from 1,139 applicants), 2016
 Dr. C.F. Koo and Cecilia Koo Fellowship for Outstanding Graduate Student in East Asian Studies, UC Berkeley Institute of East Asian Studies, 2017
 Long-Ling Hsiao Chu and Chao Chi Chu Fellowship in Chinese Studies, UC Berkeley Center for Chinese Studies, 2017
 UC Berkeley Center for Chinese Studies Dissertation Fellowship, 2016–17
 Helen Gan and Richard Aston Fellowship, 2015–16
 UC Berkeley Institute of East Asian Studies Haas Junior Scholars Program for Doctoral Candidates, 2015–16
 China Times Cultural Foundation Young Scholars Award, 2015
 Leo Lowenthal Fellowship, UC Berkeley Department of Sociology, 2015
 Republic of China East Asian Fellowship, UC Berkeley Center for Chinese Studies, 2015
 Taiwanese-American Foundation of Boston University Fellowship, 2015
 UC Berkeley Center for Chinese Studies Summer Research Grant, 2014
 UC Berkeley Department of Sociology Small Research Grant, 2013–14
 Institute for Humane Studies, Bernard Marcus Fellowship, 2013–14
 UC Berkeley Graduate Division Summer Grant, 2013
 Institute for Humane Studies, Baxter Fellowship, 2012–13
 Yale-China Association Teaching Fellowship, 2008–10

Teaching

Political Sociology (fall 2025, fall 2023)
Nations and Nationalism (fall 2025, spring 2023, spring 2022)
Sociology of Language (spring 2025)
Classical Sociological Theory (fall 2024, fall 2022, fall 2021)
Contemporary Sociological Theory (spring 2024)
Field Research in Contemporary China (spring 2024)
Race and Ethnicity (fall 2023)
Methods in Historical Sociology (spring 2023)
Contemporary American Society (spring 2022)

Service

TO THE DISCIPLINE	Peer reviewer, <i>Journal of Asian Studies</i> , <i>Social Problems</i> , <i>Sungkyun Journal of East Asian Studies</i> , <i>Sociology of Development</i> , <i>Journal of Asian Sociology</i>
TO THE DEPARTMENT	Member, Graduate Studies Committee (2024–) Member, International Programs Committee (2023–) Member, Undergraduate Studies Committee (2023) Member, Curriculum Committee (2023–24) Member, Doctoral Studies Committee (2022–23) Colloquium and Proseminar Coordinator (fall 2024, fall 2022)

Languages	Mandarin Chinese (advanced fluency) Spanish (advanced)
Professional affiliations	American Sociological Association Association for Asian Studies Yale-China Association
Other skills	Organist, St. John's Episcopal Cathedral, Taipei
References	JOHN LIE Distinguished Professor Department of Sociology University of California, Berkeley 410 Social Sciences Building Berkeley, CA 94720 johnlie@berkeley.edu MARA LOVEMAN Professor Department of Sociology University of California, Berkeley 410 Social Sciences Building Berkeley, CA 94720 mloveman@berkeley.edu WEN-HSIN YEH Richard H. and Laurie C. Morrison Chair Professor & Distinguished Professor Department of History University of California, Berkeley 3229 Dwinelle Hall Berkeley, CA 94720 sha@berkeley.edu PAMELA CROSSLEY Charles and Elfriede Collis Professor of History Professor of Asian and Middle Eastern Studies Department of History, 308 Carson Hall 6107 Dartmouth College 27 North Main Street Hanover, NH 03755 crossley@dartmouth.edu